



MAC PREVIEW



PREDICTED ORDER OF FINISH

	1	MIAMI (OHIO) REDHAWKS
	2	WESTERN MICHIGAN BRONCOS
	3	CENTRAL MICHIGAN CHIPPEWAS
	4	TOLEDO ROCKETS
	5	OHIO BOBCATS
	6	BUFFALO BULLS
	7	BOWLING GREEN FALCONS
	8	EASTERN MICHIGAN EAGLES
	9	AKRON ZIPS
	10	KENT STATE GOLDEN FLASHES
	11	BALL STATE CARDINALS
	12	SACRAMENTO STATE HORNETS
	13	UMASS MINUTEMEN

MAC CHAMPIONSHIP

MIAMI (OHIO) OVER WESTERN MICHIGAN



JOIN COLLEGE FOOTBALL EXPERT STEVEN LASSAN AT ATHLONSPORTS.COM FOR A LOOK AT SECOND- AND THIRD-TEAM SELECTIONS

ALL-MAC TEAM

FIRST-TEAM OFFENSE

QB	BROC LOWRY	Western Michigan
RB	JORDAN GANT	Akron
RB	JALEN BUCKLEY	Western Michigan
AP	RODNEY NELSON	Miami (Ohio)
WR	MARCEL WILLIAMS	Akron
WR	LANGSTON LEWIS	Central Michigan
WR	NICK DEVEREAUX	Eastern Michigan
TE	JOSHUA LONG	Eastern Michigan
C	NICHOLAS GALLEGOS	Eastern Michigan
OL	ERIC SMITH	Miami (Ohio)
OL	EVAN MALCORE	Miami (Ohio)
OL	STEPHEN GALES	Toledo
OL	CHAD SCHUSTER	Western Michigan

FIRST-TEAM DEFENSE

DL	ANDREW ZOCK	Toledo
DL	BAI JOBE	Miami (Ohio)
DL	SCOOP GARDNER JR.	Western Michigan
DL	CARTER EVANS	Eastern Michigan
LB	CJ YOUNG	Miami (Ohio)
LB	TYLER MARTIN	UMass
LB	BLAYNE MYRICK	Miami (Ohio)
LB	DORIAN PRINGLE	Bowling Green
CB	JOSHUA FRANKLIN	Western Michigan
CB	MYCHAL YHARBROUGH	Miami (Ohio)
S	BRYCE LLEWELLYN	Eastern Michigan
S	DJ WALKER	Ohio

FIRST-TEAM SPECIALISTS

K	REICE GRIFFITH	Toledo
P	PIERSE STANTON	Miami (Ohio)
KR	DA'REALYST CLARK	Kent State
PR	BRYSON HAMMER	Toledo

BOWL PROJECTIONS

Cure: Western Michigan vs. East Carolina

Famous Idaho Potato: Toledo vs. North Dakota State

Boca Raton: Miami (Ohio) vs. Troy

Frisco: Central Michigan vs. Louisiana Tech

Arizona: Ohio vs. Air Force

COORDINATOR CAROUSEL

BOWLING GREEN

Offense: New: Greg Nosal

Old: Travis Partridge

Defense: New: Joe Bowden

Old: Brandon Fisher

BUFFALO

Offense: New: Tony Tokarz

Old: Dave Patenaude

Defense: New: Brian Dougherty

Old: Joe Bowen

EASTERN MICHIGAN

Defense: New: Kasey Teegardin, Tate

Oml; Old: Ben Needham

MIAMI (OHIO)

Offense: New: Gus Ragland

Old: Pat Welsh

OHIO

Defense: New: Kurt Mattix

Old: John Hauser

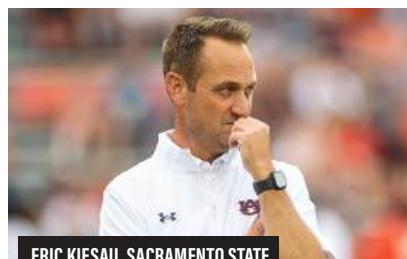
SACRAMENTO STATE

Offense: New: Eric Kiesau, Eric Scott

Old: Kenneth Merchant

Defense: New: Adam Clark, Kenwick

Thompson; Old: Marcus Patton



ERIC KIESAU, SACRAMENTO STATE

TOLEDO

Offense: New: Cris Reiser

Old: Mike Hallett, Robert Weiner

Defense: New: Jahmal Brown

Old: Vince Kehres

UMASS

Offense: New: Max Warner

Old: Mike Bajakian

WESTERN MICHIGAN

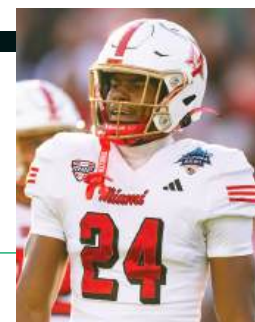
Defense: New: Greer Martini, Seth

Payne; Old: Chris O'Leary

TOP 10 RECRUITS

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	RATING	NAT. RANK
1. Malachi Ervin	EDGE	Buffalo	★★★	534
2. Kentrell White	TE	Bowling Green	★★★	772
3. Brandon Jenkins	ATH	Ohio	★★★	811
4. Chase Enlow	RB	Buffalo	★★★	826
5. Tayshon Bardo	WR	Ball State	★★★	994

BROC LOWRY, WESTERN MICHIGAN
MYCHAL YHARBROUGH, MIAMI (OHIO)



TOP TRANSFERS

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	FORMER SCHOOL
1. Andrew Zock	DL	Toledo	Mercer
Zock is a disruptive pass-rusher who was the best defender at the FCS level last season.			
2. Austin Novosad	QB	Bowling Green	Oregon
The former blue-chip recruit spent years in one of the best QB rooms in the nation.			
3. CJ Miller	RB	Toledo	Mercer
Miller tallied more than 1,200 yards from scrimmage on his way to all-conference honors.			
4. Reese Poffenbarger	QB	Akron	North Texas
The well-traveled Poffenbarger is a few years removed from leading the FCS in passing.			
5. Adjatay Dabbs	WR	Toledo	Mercer
Dabbs is a decorated deep threat who followed head coach Mike Jacobs to the MAC.			
6. Rodney Nelson	RB	Miami (Ohio)	Monmouth
Nelson finished third in the FCS with more than 1,800 rushing yards in 2025.			
7. Vaughn Blue	RB	Central Michigan	Liberty
Efficient for the Flames in spurts, Blue is ready to handle a larger workload.			
8. Braydon Bennett	RB	Eastern Michigan	Virginia Tech
Bennett, a seventh-year senior, is a dynamic pass-catching threat out of the backfield.			
9. Matt Vezza	QB	Ohio	New Hampshire
Vezza's mobility will be a bonus as he adjusts to life in the FBS.			
10. William Watson III	QB	UMass	Virginia Tech
Watson has shown enough promise to invigorate the lowest-scoring team in the country.			

RECRUITING RANKINGS BY SCHOOL

1. Bowling Green (80)	6. Ohio (105)	11. Toledo (125)
2. Central Michigan (85)	7. Kent State (111)	12. Sacramento State (126)
3. Miami (Ohio) (88)	8. Ball State (114)	13. Akron (132)
4. Eastern Michigan (97)	9. Western Michigan (116)	
5. Buffalo (102)	10. UMass (117)	

*Rankings per Rivals;
National ranking in parentheses*

GAMES TO WATCH

Sept. 19 Miami (Ohio) at Cincinnati

Sept. 26 Boise State at W. Michigan

Oct. 17 W. Michigan at C. Michigan

Oct. 24 Miami (Ohio) at C. Michigan

Oct. 24 W. Michigan at Toledo

Nov. 3 Buffalo at Miami (Ohio)

Nov. 4 C. Michigan vs. E. Michigan (Detroit)

Nov. 10 Ohio at Miami (Ohio)

Nov. 17 E. Michigan at W. Michigan

Nov. 18 Bowling Green at Toledo

Nov. 24 Miami (Ohio) at W. Michigan

Nov. 27 Toledo at Ohio

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	RATING	NAT. RANK
6. Elijah Durham-Smith	EDGE	Bowling Green	★★★	1044
7. Qur'an McNeill	QB	Buffalo	★★★	1055
8. Travis Robertson	OT	Bowling Green	★★★	1159
9. Sharard Vaughn III	LB	Toledo	★★★	1160
10. Jarin Mock	QB	Bowling Green	★★★	1188

Rankings per Rivals industry ranking



AKRON ZIPS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 125 | MAC PREDICTION: 9 | 2025 RECORD: 5-7, 4-4 MAC

OFFENSE Akron is handing the offense over to transfer quarterback Reese Poffenbarger, who has served as a backup to Cam Ward at Miami (Fla.) and Drew Mestemaker at North Texas the past two seasons. He was very productive at FCS UAlbany, throwing for 60 touchdowns and running for another eight when he started in 2022 and '23, averaging 3,306 yards passing and completing 60% of his passes.

Poffenbarger will have experience at the skill positions around him. Fifth-year senior Jordan Gant returns after rushing for 1,032 yards in his first season following his transfer from FCS Tennessee State. He earned second-team All-MAC honors. Backup Sean Patrick is also back after averaging 6.9 carries per game as a freshman.

Two of Akron's top three receivers are also back. Marcel Williams (641 yards) and Kyan Mason (481) combined for more than 1,000 receiving yards a year ago. Williams is an All-MAC candidate on the outside, and Mason does his damage from the slot with his shifty athleticism.

The offensive line has seven players returning who were at a minimum rotational players, and the unit has also added some transfers.

DEFENSE The secondary is the strength of a unit that was ninth in the MAC in scoring defense last season. Rodrick Hunter and Terence Thomas are names to watch, and the coaches are high on Aamii Branch at nickel. The hope is that former Oregon transfer Daymon David will return from injury to man a safety spot.

Jason Hocker takes over at middle linebacker after seeing action in five games last year. The Frazier twins, Dahvon and Jahvon, return along the defensive line and will provide support for Cyrus Durham, who will start again after a productive sophomore season. Jon'Trell Mixon and Ronald Hull were rotational players last season and give the defense needed experience.

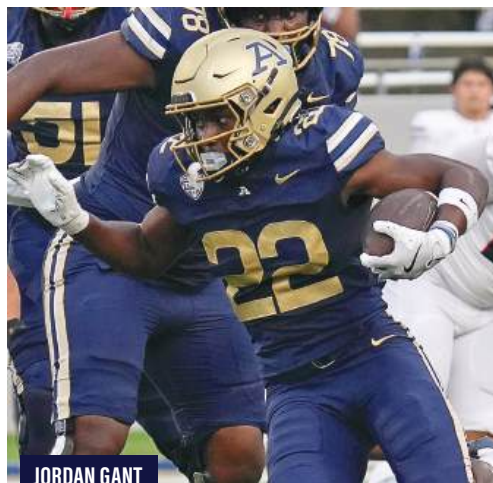
SPECIALISTS Both placekicker Matthew Schramm and punter Joseph Castle return. Schramm made 12-of-13 field goals, including 4-of-5 from beyond 40, after taking over the job early in the season. Castle averaged 42.9 yards per punt and had a long of 68 yards. Patrick will again be the primary punt returner.

FINAL ANALYSIS Akron's bowl ban for poor APR scores has been lifted, and making the postseason is a reachable goal for the Zips. Poffenbarger impressed in the spring and will be productive if the offensive line can come together. The schedule has three tough non-conference games in UNLV, Wake Forest and Minnesota, and no Sacramento State in league play, which probably makes six wins the ceiling for the Zips.

2025 RESULTS (5-7, 4-4 MAC)			2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 28	Wyoming	L 0-10	Sept. 3	at Wake Forest	1. Savion Lewis, CB	★★★
Sept. 6	at Nebraska	L 0-68	Sept. 12	Robert Morris	2. Semaj Beals, QB	★★★
Sept. 13	at UAB	L 28-31	Sept. 19	at Minnesota	3. Elzea Rollins, IOL	★★★
Sept. 20	Duquesne	W 51-7	Sept. 26	UNLV	4. Lorrans Barthelemy, IOL	★★★
Sept. 27	at Toledo	L 3-45	Oct. 3	at Central Michigan	5. Daunte Curtis, LB	★★★
Oct. 4	Central Michigan	W 28-22	Oct. 10	Eastern Michigan	6. Jasun Ridley, DL	★★★
Oct. 11	Miami (Ohio)	L 7-20	Oct. 17	at Miami (Ohio)	7. Henry Perrymond, CB	★★★
Oct. 18	at Ball State	L 28-42	Oct. 24	at Kent State	8. Jaborree Riggins, WR	★★★
Oct. 25	at Buffalo	W 24-16	Nov. 3	Ohio	9. Gentz Hilburn, WR	★★★
Nov. 4	UMass	W 44-10	Nov. 10	Western Michigan	10. Daxton Christman-Gourley, OT	★★★
Nov. 11	Kent State (ot)	L 35-42	Nov. 18	at UMass	*Per Rivals	
Nov. 18	at Bowling Green	W 19-16	Nov. 27	Buffalo		

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Joe Moorhead • Record at School: 13-35 (4 years) • Career Record: 65-60 (10 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Joe Moorhead • Defensive Coordinator: Tim Tibesar • Location: Akron, Ohio • Stadium: InfoCision Stadium-Summa Field (30,000)



JORDAN GANT

SCOUTING THE ZIPS

"Like a lot of other MAC teams, they lost some serious production to the transfer portal, especially up front. But they've got a second-team all-conference receiver, Marcel Williams, back and [Jordan Gant] is back after he ran for over 1,000 yards, so they have some returners there who have played significant snaps. ... They've got a quarterback competition, and obviously, they've still got [head coach] Joe Moorhead calling plays, so you feel pretty confident about where that's headed. You've seen the progression of the offense the last couple years. There are some holes up front that have to be filled on both sides of the ball, but for a Group of 6, I think they're a little bit better off than they've been in the past as far as losing guys that produced."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	2	MARCEL WILLIAMS (SO.)	12	Cameron Monteiro (So.)
WR	3	Kyan Mason (So.)	16	Paul Davis (So.)
WR	81	Luke Sivon (Fr.)	8	Brandon Hills (Jr.)
LT	75	Dayne Shor (Jr.)	57	Ian Falkner* (Sr.)
LG	55	Amarie Archer (Sr.)	79	Nick Stopiak (Sr.)
C	72	COLIN LYONS (SR.)	62	Max Mobley (Jr.)
RG	58	Alex Fox (Sr.)	52	Nate Hampton* (Fr.)
RT	50	ALLEN JONES JR. (SR.)	68	Jonathan Gould (Fr.)
TE	85	Conner Cravaack (Jr.)	83	Elijah Alexander* (So.)
QB	7	Reese Poffenbarger* (Sr.)	6	Brayden Roggow (So.)
RB	22	JORDAN GANT (SR.)	13	Sean Patrick (So.)

DEFENSE (2)

DE	10	CYRUS DURHAM (JR.)	50	Jahvon Frazier (So.)
NG	97	Jon'Trell Mixon (Jr.)	99	Jaiden Brown-Demery (Fr.)
DT	5	RONALD HULL (JR.)	95	Vann Kavals (Fr.)
RUSH	16	Dahvon Frazier (So.)	93	Ty Watkins (Fr.)
LB	25	Jason Hocker (So.)	45	Devin Reeves (Fr.)
LB	31	Gavin James (Fr.)	18	Dwight Nunoo* (Sr.)
CB	21	Catrell White (Jr.)	27	Keyveon Johnson (So.)
CB	15	Terence Thomas (Sr.)	17	Caiden Newsome* (Jr.)
NB	9	Aamii Branch (Jr.)	12	Iesa Jarmon (Sr.)
S	2	Daymon David (Sr.)	6	Jamari Somerville (Jr.)
S	13	Rodrick Hunter (So.)	20	Mehki Flowers (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	47	Matthew Schramm (So.)	KR	15	Terence Thomas (Sr.)
P	95	Joseph Castle (Sr.)	PR	13	Sean Patrick (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

MIKE CARDEW



DONOVAN HAMILTON

SCOUTING THE CARDINALS

"[Head coach] Mike Uremovich has been in that conference before, going back to his time at Northern Illinois. It's a hard place to recruit to. [Former head coach] Mike Neu took it as far as he possibly could take it. ... They need to either have freshmen and sophomores who can play right away and have some sort of success in a year, or you have to have guys who are committed to staying that are fourth- and fifth-year guys who are just playing against guys that are younger than them and they can sustain a whole season. No one is really going to poach from Ball State, but they're also having to go out and recruit the FCS level and get those guys to be able to play. They have a really good group of coaches that I know will get their guys to play at a high level."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (5)

WR	1	DONOVAN HAMILTON (SO.)	14	Elisha Durham (So.)
WR	10	Jamarion McDougle (Sr.)	7	CJ Nelson* (Sr.)
WR	11	Isaiah Thacker (Jr.)	5	Jabari Smith Jr.* (Jr.)
LT	66	CHRIS HOOD (SR.)	62	Sam Spicer (Fr.)
LG	75	Zach Bandy (So.)	77	Misael Sandoval* (Jr.)
C	73	COLE MOSIER (JR.)	68	Grant Haworth (So.)
RG	56	Jacob Jeudy* (Sr.)	61	Luke Dalton (Sr.)
RT	70	TRISTAN COOK (SO.)	71	Brady Barrowman (Fr.)
TE	84	TATE HOOVER (JR.)	8	Mason Riggins (Fr.)
QB	6	Keldric Luster* (Jr.)	9	Tyler Mizzell* (Jr.)
RB	4	TJ Horton (Jr.)	2	Jalen Bonds (Fr.)

DEFENSE (1)

EDGE	7	Ben Marsh (Jr.)	10	Austin Stief* (Sr.)
NG	54	Spencer Vaka (Jr.)	95	Keilan Smith* (Jr.)
DT	56	Ameir Glenn (So.)	99	Kendrick Gilbert* (Jr.)
RUSH	31	Jared Badie* (Sr.)	42	Layton Starks (So.)
LB	25	Mikeah Webster (Fr.)	30	Gavin Forsha* (Sr.)
LB	6	Cincear Lewis* (Sr.)	16	Kaleb Stewart* (So.)
SNIPER	45	Cole Earlewine (Jr.)	28	Stone Perkins (Fr.)
CB	4	WILLIZHUAN YATES (JR.)	23	Jordan Suggs (So.)
CB	0	DJ Fields (Jr.)	11	Donovan Lanier (Fr.)
S	12	Deondre Shepherd (So.)	28	Stone Perkins (Fr.)
S	1	Sterling Smith* (Jr.)	13	Kamron Chamble (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	98	Carson Holmer (Sr.)	KR	4	TJ Horton (Jr.)
P	92	Cole Stumbaugh (So.)	PR	4	Willizhuan Yates (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



BALL STATE CARDINALS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 135 | MAC PREDICTION: 11 | 2025 RECORD: 4-8, 3-5 MAC

OFFENSE The Cardinals have two transfers arriving to play quarterback, and there is a chance both will play under second-year head coach Mike Uremovich. Keldric Luster is on his third stop after SMU and Texas State and is looking to get on the field consistently for the first time. Luster is a dual threat and has the arm to make Ball State more of a passing offense than it was last year, when it threw only 33% of the time. Tyler Mizzell went from Wake Forest to Division II Concord University (W.Va.). He is more of a pass-first QB but still has mobility.

The wide receiver room is deeper and faster than a year ago. Donovan Hamilton is a potential All-MAC player after finishing second on the team with 244 receiving yards on 20 catches. Transfers CJ Nelson, Jabari Smith Jr., DJ Young and Corey Thompson Jr. give BSU smaller, quicker threats in the slots.

The offensive line returns starters at center and both tackles, with right tackle Tristan Cook a potential All-MAC candidate. The offensive line is the strongest unit on offense.

Running backs TJ Horton (60 carries, 180 yards) and Jalen Bonds return, with the more physical Bonds coming off a pair of starts at the end of the season.

DEFENSE The defense has an influx of transfers who will determine if the unit can rise from No. 10 in the MAC. Rush end Jared Badie arrives from San Diego State after playing with Illinois out of high school. He is expected to make an immediate impact in his only season at Ball State.

Cornerback Willizhuan Yates is a three-year starter and the team's top player in coverage. DJ Fields is moving from safety to corner after racking up 34 tackles a year ago. Deondre Shepherd has starting experience at safety, and hopes are high for incoming Purdue transfer Sterling Smith.

The defensive line needs players who were reserves last season to step up. Ameir Glenn and Ben Marsh were rotational players, and Spencer Vaka will be elevated at the nose guard spot.

SPECIALISTS Senior Carson Holmer will be given a shot as the placekicker again. He won the job last spring but lost it as he struggled early in the season, going just 3-for-7 on field goals with a long of 23 yards. Cole Stumbaugh will be the punter.

FINAL ANALYSIS There are too many unproven areas to project the Cardinals to get to a bowl for the first time since 2021. The hope is that one of the quarterbacks will own the position behind a stout offensive line. Defensively, the secondary has potential, and the linebackers have some difference-makers, but the Cardinals may have difficulty winning up front.

2025 RESULTS (4-8, 3-5 MAC)

Aug. 30	at Purdue	L	0-31
Sept. 6	at Auburn	L	3-42
Sept. 13	New Hampshire	W	34-29
Sept. 20	at UConn	L	25-31
Oct. 4	Ohio	W	20-14
Oct. 11	at Western Michigan	L	0-42
Oct. 18	Akron	W	42-28
Oct. 25	at Northern Illinois	L	7-21
Nov. 5	Kent State	W	17-13
Nov. 15	Eastern Michigan	L	9-24
Nov. 22	at Toledo	L	9-38
Nov. 29	at Miami (Ohio)	L	24-45

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	at Ohio State
Sept. 12	Stony Brook
Sept. 19	at Liberty
Sept. 26	at Kent State
Oct. 3	Toledo
Oct. 10	at Northwestern
Oct. 17	at Bowling Green
Oct. 24	Sacramento State
Nov. 4	at UMass
Nov. 11	Buffalo
Nov. 17	at Ohio
Nov. 28	Central Michigan

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Tayshon Bardo, WR	★★★
2.	Mark Hanniford, WR	★★★
3.	Mason Atkins, QB	★★★
4.	Stone Perkins, CB	★★★
5.	Brady Weber, OT	★★★
6.	Zyon Hill, S	★★★
7.	Dominic Infelise, DL	★★★
8.	Ace Cooper, WR	★★★
9.	Nolan Cicero, OT	★★★
10.	Evan Downer, EDGE	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Mike Uremovich • Record at School: 4-8 (1 year) • Career Record: 60-64 (11 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Mike Uremovich • Defensive Coordinator: Jeff Knowles • Location: Muncie, Ind. • Stadium: Scheumann Stadium (22,500)



BOWLING GREEN FALCONS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 122 | MAC PREDICTION: 7 | 2025 RECORD: 4-8, 2-6 MAC

OFFENSE Oregon transfer Austin Novosad finally gets the chance to start after being QB2 behind Bo Nix, Dillon Gabriel and Dante Moore for the Ducks. The former highly regarded 4-star recruit is mobile and has a strong arm. He was in competition with Div. II Assumption transfer Jay Kastantin in the spring, but expect Novosad to be the guy in the fall.

The Falcons ran the ball 62% of the time, and if that ratio holds, expect Austyn Dendy to get a lot of work. The former Missouri running back came on strong at the tail end of 2025, rushing for 100-plus yards in three straight games. He is BG's leading returning rusher and has a shot at 1,000 yards if he stays healthy.

The offensive line gets a reboot with all five starters gone. James Thomas Jr. had two starts and played 405 snaps, so his experience will pay dividends at right tackle. Alexis Sanchez was a rotational player at guard.

The top pass-catcher at BGSU the past three years has been a tight end, and sophomore Jeremiah Scoby will have a chance to be that featured player. Wideouts Brennan Ridley and Winn Sharp will move up from reserve roles a year ago.

DEFENSE The front six has the potential to be strong for the Falcons. Defensive end Myles Bradley and defensive tackle Eriq George (son of head coach Eddie George) led the team in sacks with five and four, respectively, and will look to increase those numbers this year.

Middle linebacker Dorian Pringle was off to a fast start in 2025 with 27 tackles, two forced fumbles, an interception and a fumble recovery before being lost for the season in Week 3 against Liberty. He has a chance to be an All-MAC player if he can stay healthy. Coaches also have high hopes for Purdue transfer Sanders Ellis.

Safety Kal-El Pascal is the only returning starter in the secondary. He was second on the team with 80 tackles and also recorded an interception and a fumble recovery. Cornerback JoJo Johnson is projected to start after leading the MAC with 13 pass breakups in 2025.

SPECIALISTS The Falcons will depend on walk-on placekicker Travis Kenner, which isn't always ideal. Ryan Kingston averaged 41 yards per punt last season at FCS Southeast Missouri State and was second-team All-OVC.

FINAL ANALYSIS Eddie George enters Year 2 with several unknowns but a potentially elite quarterback in Novosad. The running game has a dependable back, but there are questions along the offensive line. Defensively, the secondary isn't deep, but there are difference-makers in the first two levels. A bowl berth is the ceiling for this squad.

2025 RESULTS (4-8, 2-6 MAC)

Aug. 28	Lafayette	W	26-7
Sept. 6	at Cincinnati	L	20-34
Sept. 13	Liberty	W	23-13
Sept. 20	at Louisville	L	17-40
Sept. 27	at Ohio	L	20-35
Oct. 11	Toledo	W	28-23
Oct. 18	Central Michigan	L	6-27
Oct. 25	at Kent State	L	21-24
Nov. 1	Buffalo	L	3-28
Nov. 8	at Eastern Michigan	L	21-27
Nov. 18	Akron	L	16-19
Nov. 25	at UMass	W	45-14

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	Tarleton State
Sept. 12	at Nebraska
Sept. 19	at Iowa State
Sept. 26	South Florida
Oct. 3	at Miami (Ohio)
Oct. 10	Sacramento State
Oct. 17	Ball State
Oct. 24	at Buffalo
Oct. 31	at W. Michigan
Nov. 10	Kent State
Nov. 18	at Toledo
Nov. 28	UMass

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1. Elijah Durham-Smith, EDGE ★★
2. Derron Gray Jr., TE ★★
3. Kentrell White, TE ★★
4. Jarin Mock, QB ★★
5. Maddox Hunstad, TE ★★
6. Pete Pendergest, OT ★★
7. Travis Robertson, OT ★★
8. Trent Merrell, EDGE ★★
9. Pauly Sadler, WR ★★
10. Chris Newell Jr., S ★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Eddie George • Record at School: 4-8 (1 year) • Career Record: 28-30 (5 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Greg Nosal • Defensive Coordinator: Joe Bowden • Location: Bowling Green, Ohio • Stadium: Doyt L. Perry Stadium (24,000)



KAL-EL PASCAL

SCOUTING THE FALCONS

"They've got [Oregon transfer quarterback] Austin Novosad. I think in the MAC, if you have a quarterback, you're gonna be pretty good. Especially as long as you have somebody who doesn't turn the ball over. ... They've brought in some transfers who were backups at bigger universities who just maybe got to the point where they had one or two years left in their careers, and they just want to be able to play. They're gonna be a team that could shock some people, just because of the history of Bowling Green the last few years since Dino Babers left to go to Syracuse. But I think they'll be a solid team in the MAC."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	18	Winn Sharp (So.)	32	Nick Sowell* (Jr.)
WR	5	Brennan Ridley (Jr.)	11	Austin Clay (So.)
LT	65	Gabe Funk* (So.)	58	Ethan Kraatz (Fr.)
LG	78	Alexis Sanchez (Sr.)	66	Zane Panchula (Fr.)
C	54	Brody Bolyn (Jr.)	53	Masyn Zahursky (Fr.)
RG	70	Alex Harris (So.)	73	Caden Campbell (So.)
RT	77	James Thomas Jr. (Jr.)	50	Vincent Giordano (Fr.)
TE	86	Jeremiah Scoby (So.)	88	Carsen Melvin (Fr.)
TE	89	BLANE CLEAVER (SR.)	82	Eli Jacon-Duffy (So.)
QB	16	Austin Novosad* (Jr.)	19	Jay Kastantin* (Jr.)
RB	14	Austyn Dendy (So.)	22	Nakai Amachree (So.)

DEFENSE (2)

DE	33	Jaimion Olverson (Fr.)	Kade Kostus* (Sr.)
DT	5	Eriq George (Sr.)	Dior Garner (Fr.)
DT	88	Selah Brown* (Sr.)	57 Dayln White (Jr.)
DE	23	Myles Bradley (Sr.)	48 Quentin Lewis (Fr.)
LB	12	Sanders Ellis* (Jr.)	35 Cashmire Lewis (Fr.)
MLB	3	DORIAN PRINGLE (SO.)	18 Andrew Hines III (So.)
LB	44	AJ Odom (Sr.)	Kingston Seals (Fr.)
CB	10	JoJo Johnson (Sr.)	26 Josira Andrews (So.)
CB	41	Drey Braxton* (Jr.)	27 Nick Sawyer* (Sr.)
S	0	KAL-EL PASCAL (JR.)	31 D'kyah Banks (So.)
S	15	Preston EstoEsta (So.)	19 Jahai Johnson (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	85	Travis Kenner (Jr.)	KR	22	Nakai Amachree (So.)
P	30	Ryan Kingston* (Sr.)	PR	5	Brennan Ridley (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

ISAIAH VAZQUEZ/GETTY IMAGES



TERRANCE SHELTON JR.

SCOUTING THE BULLS

"They lost their defensive coordinator, Joe Bowen, to Pitt, and he was a fantastic defensive coordinator. He's very smart. And they lost their Mike linebacker, Red Murdock. He made the show go for them. They're a solid squad. I just don't know if they have the pieces to still compete in the MAC. ... I know that [head coach] Pete Lembo is awesome. Those guys are gonna win. He just does a good job of managing the game and not overcooking it. ... They're a tough out. Lembo coaches them well. They're a pain in the a— on special teams, and I know they had some quarterback issues in the second half of the season that started that collapse, but I wouldn't count them out of competing for a MAC title."

— An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (2)

WR	8	JASAIAH GATHINGS (SR.)	11	Dwayne Early Jr. (Fr.)
WR	6	Chance Morrow (Sr.)	1	Phillip Folmar (Fr.)
WR	3	Patrick Clacks III (So.)	84	Tyrell Simmons Jr. (So.)
LT	59	Gabriel Arena (Jr.)	71	Caleb Watts (Fr.)
LG	62	Paul Clark (So.)	78	Joe Crocker* (Jr.)
C	55	Thomas Barr (Fr.)	74	Nino Francavilla* (So.)
RG	67	ALEX HEININGER (SR.)	69	Jackson Bellamy (So.)
RT	51	Tyrone Davis (So.)	77	Jackson Davenport (Fr.)
TE	86	Michael Gelatko (Fr.)	5	Clint Walker (Sr.)
QB	7	Jason Wright (Fr.)	16	Elijah Holmes* (Jr.)
RB	25	Terrance Shelton Jr. (Jr.)	4	Messiah Burch (Jr.)

DEFENSE (4)

DE	30	Jacari Bennett (So.)	17	Logan Goodwin* (Jr.)
DT	99	CORNELL EVANS (SR.)	55	Mason Nickel* (So.)
DT	88	Rex Stinchcomb (Fr.)	97	Christopher Climes (Fr.)
DE	11	Will Clark (So.)	15	Sedrick Vessah* (Jr.)
LB	13	Joey Cheshire* (Sr.)	18	George Hill (Fr.)
LB	2	Stevie Bracey* (Sr.)	44	Zach Bergmann* (Sr.)
CB	0	KOBI BLACKWELL (SO.)	3	Oliver Bridges (Sr.)
CB	9	KEONTEZ BRADLEY (SR.)	8	Ramari Taylor (So.)
NB	1	SAVEON BROWN (SR.)	33	Jordan Owens (Jr.)
S	6	Miles Greer (Sr.)	7	John Keough (Jr.)
S	4	Ronnell Davis (So.)	23	Xavier Leonard (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	31	Oliver Hautanen (Fr.)	KR	25	Terrance Shelton Jr. (Jr.)
P	90	Ethan Stumpf (So.)	PR	6	Miles Greer (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



BUFFALO BULLS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 118 | MAC PREDICTION: 6 | 2025 RECORD: 5-7, 4-4 MAC

OFFENSE The Bulls have only two returning starters on an offense that ranked No. 93 nationally in points per game (24.0) last season. At quarterback, Jason Wright is a promising redshirt freshman with good size and athletic ability. He has a high ceiling as a two-way threat, and it will be worth watching how quickly he can pick up new offensive coordinator Tony Tokarz's system.

There is some experience in the backfield with Terrance Shelton Jr., the team's second-leading rusher a year ago (244 yards, one TD) and Messiah Burch, a gadget back who is capable of explosive plays. The wide receiver room lost two All-MAC players to the transfer portal and must be rebuilt. Jasaiah Gathings is the top returner with 410 yards and will be Wright's top target. Chance Morrow is a 6-foot-4 red-zone threat, and Dwayne Early Jr. and Tyrell Simmons Jr. turned heads during the spring.

On the offensive line, only one starter returns in guard Alex Heininger. This is the area with the most questions on offense.

DEFENSE Buffalo's secondary has two experienced corners returning in Kobi Blackwell (seven starts) and Keontez Bradley (six starts), and nickel SaVeon Brown (eight starts) is expected to be the biggest playmaker on the backline. Miles Greer was in the safety rotation a year ago and was third on the team in tackles. The Bulls ranked No. 23 in the nation in pass defense (186.4 ypg) last season.

The defensive line will have to be rebuilt, with defensive tackle Cornell Evans the lone returning starter. Will Clark had a nice spring at defensive end after contributing on special teams last season, and transfer edges Logan Goodwin and Sedrick Vessah were all-league at their previous stops.

The linebacking corps lost All-American Red Murdock and will try to piece it together with transfers and backups from last season. FCS Cornell transfer Joey Cheshire impressed coaches early, and Virginia transfer Stevie Bracey looks like he will play a big role. Redshirt freshman George Hill also will challenge for a rotational spot.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Oliver Hautanen did not see any action as a true freshman last season, and Ethan Stumpf has yet to punt. The Bulls also brought in Andrew VanSlyke from James Madison to compete for the punter spot.

FINAL ANALYSIS Head coach Pete Lembo is starting over in a lot of ways, and a lot of the rebuild will depend on the quarterback. Wright will likely have some growing pains, but he has potential. The lines need to be better than a year ago, and it is not clear that the Bulls upgraded there. Reaching a second bowl in Lembo's first three years will be a challenge.

2025 RESULTS (5-7, 4-4 MAC)

Aug. 28	at Minnesota	L	10-23
Sept. 6	Saint Francis (Pa.)	W	45-6
Sept. 13	at Kent State	W	31-28
Sept. 20	Troy	L	17-21
Sept. 27	UConn	L	17-20
Oct. 4	Eastern Michigan (ot)	W	31-30
Oct. 18	at UMass	W	28-21
Oct. 25	Akron	L	16-24
Nov. 1	at Bowling Green	W	28-3
Nov. 12	at Central Michigan	L	19-38
Nov. 19	Miami (Ohio)	L	20-37
Nov. 28	Ohio	L	26-31

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 3	UAlbany
Sept. 12	at FIU
Sept. 19	at Penn State
Sept. 26	Robert Morris
Oct. 3	Western Michigan
Oct. 10	at Toledo
Oct. 17	UMass
Oct. 24	Bowling Green
Nov. 3	at Miami (Ohio)
Nov. 11	at Ball State
Nov. 18	Central Michigan
Nov. 27	at Akron

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Malachi Ervin, EDGE	★★★
2.	Aiden Anderson, EDGE	★★★
3.	Qur'an McNeill, QB	★★★
4.	Chase Enlow, RB	★★★
5.	Jack Garbolino, LB	★★★
6.	Preston Lunsford, EDGE	★★★
7.	William Reed, DL	★★★
8.	Royce Rogers, DL	★★★
9.	Na'Rod Jarvis, LB	★★★
10.	Marco Cate, IOL	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Pete Lembo • Record at School: 14-11 (2 years) • Career Record: 126-76 (17 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Tony Tokarz • Defensive Coordinator: Brian Dougherty • Location: Amherst, N.Y. • Stadium: Broadview Stadium (25,013)



CENTRAL MICHIGAN CHIPPEWAS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 98 | MAC PREDICTION: 3 | 2025 RECORD: 7-6, 5-3 MAC

OFFENSE Second-year head coach Matt Drinkall plans to use multiple quarterbacks again this season. Angel Flores will primarily be used as a running threat, and Jadyn Glasser is a traditional pocket passer. Flores missed four games due to injury last season, but he had a team-high 107 rushing attempts for 527 yards and eight TDs. He threw just 28 passes, completing 19. Glasser has played in six games over two years but will be featured plenty after a strong spring.

Vaughn Blue arrives from Liberty after three up-and-down years and will take over RB1 duties. Brock Townsend averaged just over six carries per game last season and will be a factor.

Senior Langston Lewis, a third-team All-MAC honoree, gives Glasser and Flores a reliable target as the only returning starting wideout. Sophomore Nasir Williams also had a strong spring.

The offensive line is deeper and more experienced. Left guard Jacob Russell started every game last year and is an all-league candidate.

DEFENSE Three starters return on a unit that ranked seventh in the MAC in total defense. Quavion Bird is back at defensive tackle after taking over the position halfway through the year. Korver Demma is another edge with starting experience, and the coaching staff is excited about sophomore JJ Douglas, who moved early in his true freshman season from tight end to defensive end and looks like he will break out in Year 2.

The linebacker room has to be completely rebuilt. Xavier White, whose father played in the NFL and great uncle Charles White won the Heisman Trophy in 1979, was in the rotation last season. Victor Earl, another projected starter, saw limited action off the bench last season.

In the secondary, corner Jaion Jackson will be a third-year starter and is the unquestioned leader of the back line. JaJuan Jones and Ty Williams will battle for the spot opposite Jackson. Safeties will be inexperienced, with Justin Taylor transferring in from Wyoming.

SPECIALISTS Declan Duley will be back at punter. He averaged 41.1 yards per punt in his first year after transferring from Illinois. Caden VanHuis, who played in the Under Armour All-America game as a senior in high school, will take over the placekicking duties.

FINAL ANALYSIS Can CMU make it to back-to-back bowls? The Chippewas miss two of the four other MAC teams that reached the postseason last year, but they also play national champion runner-up Miami (Fla.) and New Mexico (9-4 last season) on the road in non-league play. The defense has a lot of questions at all three levels, but the offense has potential if Glasser can translate his spring performance at QB into fall production.

2025 RESULTS (7-6, 5-3 MAC)	2026 SCHEDULE	TOP 10 RECRUITS*
Aug. 29 at San José State W 16-14	Sept. 5 at New Mexico	1. Trav Moore, RB ★★
Sept. 6 at Pitt L 17-45	Sept. 12 Colgate	2. Colton Benaitis, S ★★
Sept. 13 at Michigan L 3-63	Sept. 19 Wyoming	3. Drew Esper, LB ★★
Sept. 20 Wagner W 49-10	Sept. 26 at Miami (Fla.)	4. Elijah Reynolds, LB ★★
Sept. 27 Eastern Michigan W 24-13	Oct. 3 Akron	5. Lucas Hoffmeyer, TE ★★
Oct. 4 at Akron L 22-28	Oct. 10 at Ohio	6. Kobe Hendricks, RB ★★
Oct. 18 at Bowling Green W 27-6	Oct. 17 Western Michigan	7. Wyatt Graffin, IOL ★★
Oct. 25 UMass W 38-13	Oct. 24 Miami (Ohio)	8. Matt Sexton, EDGE ★★
Nov. 1 at Western Michigan L 21-24	Nov. 4 Eastern Michigan#	9. Zack Wagner, TE ★★
Nov. 12 Buffalo W 38-19	Nov. 11 Sacramento State	10. JaJuan Jones, S ★★
Nov. 19 at Kent State W 28-16	Nov. 18 at Buffalo	
Nov. 29 Toledo L 3-21	Nov. 28 at Ball State	
Dec. 26 vs. Northwestern # L 7-34		
#GameAbove Sports Bowl	#Detroit	*Per Rivals
TEAM INFORMATION		
Head Coach: Matt Drinkall • Record at School: 7-6 (1 year)		
Career Record: 49-23 (6 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Jim Chapin		
Defensive Coordinator: Sean Cronin • Location: Mount Pleasant, Mich.		
Stadium: Kelly/Shorts Stadium (35,127)		



BROCK TOWNSEND

SCOUTING THE CHIPPEWAS

"[Head coach] Matt Drinkall is doing a great job at that place. He's built a culture coming from Army. He's got a good group of young coaches, and guys who are getting their first shot at this level. He's doing good for what he has. ... Yes, that's a very hard school to recruit to. You're in the middle of the state of Michigan. There's literally nothing around that place. It's a place that if you can win, when you've got the iron hot, you've gotta get out because it's not gonna last long. You're gonna find a spark every once in a while, and I think that's what [Drinkall] will do there, and then he's gotta bounce from there."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	20	LANGSTON LEWIS (SR.)	9	Justin Ruffin Jr. (So.)
WR	17	Braylen Naves (Fr.)	16	Shawn Foster II* (Jr.)
WR	3	Nasir Williams (So.)	81	Tayte Vanderleest (Jr.)
LT	69	Jacob Booth (Jr.)	58	John Williams* (So.)
LG	70	JACOB RUSSELL (JR.)	60	John Iannuzzi (Sr.)
C	55	Losini Maka* (Sr.)	72	Trevor Swan* (Sr.)
RG	66	MATTHEW NEHF (JR.)	59	Brady Ploucha (Sr.)
RT	76	MARTIN KOIVISTO (SR.)	54	Triston Pierre (Fr.)
TE	41	Rusty VanWetzinga IV (Jr.)	85	Myles Peters (So.)
QB	7	Angel Flores (Sr.)	5	Jadyn Glasser (So.)
RB	24	Vaughn Blue* (Jr.)	2	Brock Townsend (So.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	5	KORVER DEMMA (JR.)	48	Nathan VanTimmeren (Jr.)
DT	96	QUAVION BIRD (SO.)	95	Joey VanWetzinga (So.)
DT	92	Jaxon Cherry* (Jr.)	97	Max Van Fleet (Sr.)
DE	85	JJ Douglas (So.)	6	Hunter Zirkle* (Jr.)
LB	8	Victor Earl (So.)	33	Elijah Reynolds (Fr.)
LB	11	Xavier White (Jr.)	30	Antonio Cherry Jr.* (So.)
LB	34	Drew Esper (Fr.)	10	Jeremiah Alston (Jr.)
CB	20	JaJuan Jones (Fr.)	24	Ty Williams* (Sr.)
CB	4	JAION JACKSON (JR.)	12	Donavan Philord* (So.)
S	14	Justin Taylor* (Jr.)	27	Tysen Campbell (So.)
S	19	Darrell Bryant Jr.* (Sr.)	37	Colton Benaitis (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	38	Caden VanHuis (Fr.)	KR	9	Justin Ruffin Jr. (So.)
P	18	Declan Duley (Jr.)	PR	9	Justin Ruffin Jr. (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

JOSEPH WEISER/ICON SPORTS WIRE VIA GETTY IMAGES



NOAH KIM

SCOUTING THE EAGLES

"I thought they were really, really well-coached when we faced them last year. Coming into it, I didn't think they were overly talented, but they had a really, really good game plan. Defensively, they didn't overcook it. Schematically, they were sound. Up front, that's what stood out to me the most. ... In the portal, they got a guy, [Oklahoma State offensive tackle transfer] Tyler Brumfield, that I think is going to be a really good player for them. ... Now, you go develop somebody, they're leaving you in six to nine months. That's the new reality, so I think the expectation to make a bowl game is unrealistic at a place like that moving forward. I think [head coach] Chris Creighton does a great job, and I don't just take the coach's side."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (5)

WR	81	NICK DEVEREAUX (SR.)	23	Harold Mack (So.)
WR	17	Benson Prosper (Sr.)	18	Mekhi Fox (Jr.)
WR	11	Antonio Floyd (Jr.)	24	Joey Mattord (Sr.)
LT	68	Tyler McMillan* (Sr.)	60	Cole Powell (So.)
LG	66	JOSHUA ANDERSON (SR.)	74	Carter Miculka (Fr.)
C	65	NICHOLAS GALLEGOS (SR.)	72	Cole Dellinger* (Jr.)
RG	75	Elijah Payne* (Jr.)	78	Dennis Strey Jr. (Sr.)
RT	71	Tyler Brumfield* (Jr.)	55	Guzzy Kayed* (Jr.)
TE	87	JOSHUA LONG (JR.)	88	Tanner Lemaster (Sr.)
QB	1	NOAH KIM (SR.)	12	Jace Stuckey (Jr.)
RB	28	Braydon Bennett* (Sr.)	21	Malachi James* (Jr.)

DEFENSE (4)

DE	33	CARTER EVANS (SR.)	90	Hector Gonzalez (So.)
NT	85	Jefferson Adam (Sr.)	99	Warren-Stevens Tayou (Sr.)
DT	52	Javon Thomas (Jr.)	64	Noah Patterson (Jr.)
EDGE	54	Quincy Byas (So.)	88	Ronn Hardin (Sr.)
LB	3	BARRY MANNING (SR.)	32	Ja'Quel Mack (Sr.)
LB	11	Zach Mowchan (Sr.)	40	Bryce Eliuk (Sr.)
CB	16	Caleb Coley (Sr.)	18	Dior Boyd (Sr.)
CB	17	Caleb Dobbs (Jr.)	22	Fa'Rel Carter (Fr.)
S	6	BRYCE LLEWELLYN (SR.)	34	Ray Hester (Jr.)
SS	8	Jaivian Norman (Sr.)	29	Donmiel Rogers (So.)
FS	13	Jason Marshall (Sr.)	4	JUAN SALAS (SR.)

SPECIALISTS

K	46	Rudy Kessinger (So.)	KR	17	Benson Prosper (Sr.)
P	39	Daniel Hull (Jr.)	PR	4	Juan Salas (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



EASTERN MICHIGAN EAGLES

NATIONAL FORECAST: 124 | MAC PREDICTION: 8 | 2025 RECORD: 4-8, 3-5 MAC

OFFENSE Quarterback Noah Kim is back for his fifth year and second as the starter for Eastern Michigan. He connected on 61% of his passes and threw for 2,817 yards a year ago with 18 touchdowns and 11 interceptions. He will enter 2026 as one of the MAC's more experienced passers; this season marks the first time since 2017 that EMU is returning its starter at quarterback.

Three of Kim's top four pass-catchers return as well, with second-team All-MAC tight end Joshua Long (37 catches, 357 yards, three TDs) likely to be a featured target in his junior season. Nick Devereaux was third-team All-MAC after his 510-yard, seven-touchdown season, and Harold Mack had a 179-yard game against Miami (Ohio) last year.

The primary running back will be graduate transfer Braydon Bennett from Virginia Tech, who saw little action with the Hokies but rushed for almost 2,000 yards in four years at Coastal Carolina.

Center Nicholas Gallegos leads an offensive line that has two starters back.

DEFENSE The backline of the Eagles' defense will be deep and experienced. Bryce Llewellyn was second-team All-MAC at safety and the team's defensive MVP after recording 102 tackles. Barry Manning is capable of playing safety after being forced to start at linebacker for much of last season due to injuries. Manning tied for the team lead in tackles for a loss and was second in total tackles. Former Michigan State transfer Caleb Coley will be a full-time starter at corner.

Senior Zach Mowchan, who has battled injuries the last two seasons, will try to fortify the linebacking corps.

Veteran end Carter Evans leads the defensive line, and Jefferson Adam projects to start after missing all of 2025 with a preseason injury. The Eagles will need to improve upon a rushing defense that allowed a league-high 332.1 yards per game.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Rudy Kessinger returns after a season that saw him connect on 17-of-23 field goals. He was 8-of-14 from beyond 40 yards. Daniel Hull, who signed with Missouri out of high school, may take over the punting duties in his third year with the Eagles.

FINAL ANALYSIS Having Kim and his top receivers back is a big plus for EMU. Head coach Chris Creighton likes to maintain offensive balance, but the Eagles' passing game should be a step ahead early in the season. Defensively, EMU needs more from its front seven if it wants to contend for a bowl. EMU must find three wins beyond MAC newcomer Sacramento State, UMass and FCS Lindenwood to make the postseason.

2025 RESULTS (4-8, 3-5 MAC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	at Texas State	L	27-52	Aug. 29	Sacramento State	1. Nazir Jones-Davis, RB	★★★
Sept. 6	Long Island	L	23-28	Sept. 4	San José State	2. RJ Alphonse, EDGE	★★★
Sept. 13	at Kentucky	L	23-48	Sept. 12	at Michigan State	3. Nily Taylor, OT	★★★
Sept. 20	Louisiana	W	34-31	Sept. 19	at Wisconsin	4. Fa'Rel Carter, CB	★★★
Sept. 27	at Central Michigan	L	13-24	Sept. 26	Lindenwood	5. Nathan Piggott, TE	★★★
Oct. 4	at Buffalo (ot)	L	30-31	Oct. 3	at UMass	6. Samuel Adjini, IOL	★★★
Oct. 11	Northern Illinois	W	16-10	Oct. 10	at Akron	7. Decorie Johnson, RB	★★★
Oct. 18	at Miami (Ohio)	L	30-44	Oct. 17	Toledo	8. Kijon Braxton, EDGE	★★★
Oct. 25	Ohio	L	21-28	Oct. 24	at Ohio	9. Aaron Kearsse, S	★★★
Nov. 8	Bowling Green	W	27-21	Nov. 4	Central Michigan#	10. Elgin McDuffey, LB	★★★
Nov. 15	at Ball State	W	24-9	Nov. 17	at W. Michigan		
Nov. 25	Western Michigan	L	21-31	Nov. 24	Kent State		
				#Detroit		*Per Rivals	

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Chris Creighton • Record at School: 61-83 (12 years) • Career Record: 200-129 (29 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Mike Piatkowski • Defensive Coordinators: Tate Omli, Kasey Teegardin • Location: Ypsilanti, Mich. • Stadium: Ryneearson Stadium (26,188)



KENT STATE GOLDEN FLASHES

NATIONAL FORECAST: 126 | MAC PREDICTION: 10 | 2025 RECORD: 5-7, 4-4 MAC

OFFENSE The Golden Flashes were fortunate to hold on to quarterback Dru DeShields after he turned in a strong 2025 season. DeShields threw 18 touchdowns with only three interceptions and completed 57% of his passes in his first season. He is the top player on a unit that must improve on last season's 21.3 points per game, and DeShields gives it a chance to do that.

Tight end Terik Mulder will figure heavily in the passing attack and is an All-MAC candidate after catching 19 passes for 198 yards and four touchdowns last season. Kick return specialist Da'Realyst Clark is expected to carry more of a load at wide receiver, and slot man Wayne Harris took a big step forward in spring practice.

Spring ball did not produce a No. 1 tailback, as Cincinnati transfer Jakorion Caffey, FCS Illinois State transfer Mason King, Brandon White and Donovan Delaney Jr. will all compete in the fall. This position has the most uncertainty heading into the season.

The offensive line has holes to fill, but some incoming transfers make this unit deeper than last season.

DEFENSE Defensive tackle Thomas Aden is back after starting for the first time since transferring from Pitt. Jaihiem Roy and Antonio Bottiggi, two players who are both in their third year in the program and have worked their way to the top of the depth chart, will man the edges.

Rocco Nicholl returns to Kent State at linebacker, where he started in 2024 before spending a year at USF. He will be one of the leaders on a unit that finished 125th in FBS in total defense last season.

Both starting safeties — Derrick Jackson III and Joel Cordoba — are back, and nickel DJ Barnes played 70% of the team's snaps. The corners will be new, and there could be a learning curve there.

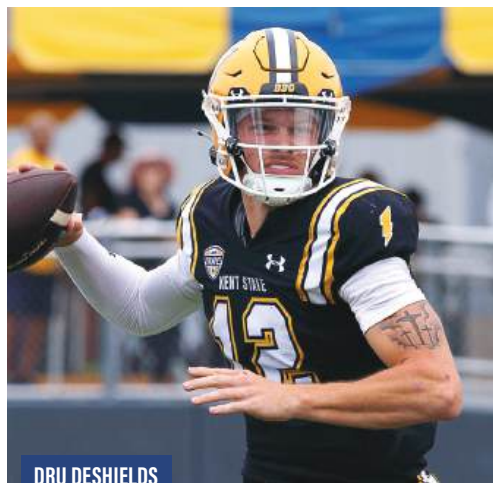
SPECIALISTS Clark took two kickoffs back for touchdowns last season and was first-team All-MAC as a return specialist. Harris also had a touchdown on a punt return and averaged a MAC-best 13.2 yards per punt return. Australian Jake Stoeckel lost his punting job last season but has regained the top spot heading into camp. There is a three-way battle for kicker.

FINAL ANALYSIS Kent State's five-win season in 2025 might not seem like much, but consider that the Flashes went 1-23 the previous two seasons and saw their head coach placed on leave last March and fired on April 11. Mark Carney sorted through the chaos, found a quarterback and went 4-4 in MAC play after starting from scratch in his first season as head coach. He needs to replace some starters lost to the portal, but because he was able to hang on to his QB, expectations have risen, although a bowl might be just out of reach this year.

2025 RESULTS (5-7, 4-4 MAC)			2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	Merrimack	W 21-17	Sept. 5	at South Carolina	1. Hunter Sprangers, OT	★★★★
Sept. 6	at Texas Tech	L 14-62	Sept. 12	Wofford	2. Daiveon Taylor, LB	★★★★
Sept. 13	Buffalo	L 28-31	Sept. 19	at Ohio State	3. Jackson Farley, RB	★★★★
Sept. 20	at Florida State	L 10-66	Sept. 26	Ball State	4. Lennox Lemon, CB	★★★★
Oct. 4	at Oklahoma	L 0-44	Oct. 3	Ohio	5. Brendyn Smith, WR	★★★★
Oct. 11	UMass	W 42-6	Oct. 10	at W. Michigan	6. Zymir Reed, WR	★★★★
Oct. 18	at Toledo	L 10-45	Oct. 17	at South Florida	7. William Johnson III, IOL	★★★★
Oct. 25	Bowling Green	W 24-21	Oct. 24	Akron	8. Kendall McNutt, LB	★★★★
Nov. 5	at Ball State	L 13-17	Oct. 30	at Sacramento St.	9. Colin Prichard, OT	★★★★
Nov. 11	at Akron (ot)	W 42-35	Nov. 10	at Bowling Green	10. Eckley Bridges, EDGE	★★★★
Nov. 19	Central Michigan	L 16-28	Nov. 17	Miami (Ohio)		
Nov. 28	at Northern Illinois	W 35-31	Nov. 24	at Eastern Michigan		

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Mark Carney • Record at School: 5-7 (1 year) • Career Record: 5-7 (1 year) • Offensive Coordinator: Clay Patterson
Defensive Coordinator: Cherokee Valeria • Location: Kent, Ohio • Stadium: Dix Stadium (25,319)



DRU DESHIELDS

SCOUTING THE GOLDEN FLASHES

"When you watched them compared to the previous two years, those guys played hard for [head coach] Mark Carney. That's not some coach slogan bulls—. You could see the belief. He's got that program in the right direction. That's one of the best turnarounds I've ever seen at the FBS level to do that in a year. ... [Quarterback] Dru DeShields doesn't turn the football over, ever. And he's just got this backyard football stuff about him. His teammates played hard for him. There's not one thing that flashes with him. He just does everything really well. ... There was some talent on the roster, but they went from not playing hard for their head coach to playing hard for their head coach, and it was so obvious on film."

— An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (6)

WR	30	Da'Realyst Clark (Sr.)	86	Jared Kelley (Jr.)
WR	33	AYDEN HARRIS (SO.)	3	Jay Jay Etheridge (Jr.)
WR	13	Ardell Banks (Jr.)	6	Wayne Harris (So.)
LT	78	TYLER MEADOWS (SO.)	70	Hudson Chasko (Sr.)
LG	54	DUSTYN MORELL (SR.)	75	Boston Crowell (Fr.)
C	50	Ben Midea* (Jr.)	77	Rico Steele (So.)
RG	72	Cecil Wilson (Jr.)	55	JAXON DUNN (SO.)
RT	76	Mofe Adewole* (Sr.)	73	William Johnson III (Fr.)
TE	89	Terik Mulder (Sr.)	18	HUNTER HOPPERTON (SR.)
QB	12	DRU DESHIELDS (JR.)	2	Nolan Good (Fr.)
RB	5	Jakorion Caffey* (So.)	21	Mason King* (Sr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	33	Jaihiem Roy (So.)	17	Semaj Bridgeman* (Jr.)
DT	5	THOMAS ADEN (SR.)	58	Darian Blachewicz (So.)
DT	55	JOSUE CORDOBA (SO.)	52	Aiden Burgess (So.)
DE	44	Antonio Bottiggi (So.)	88	Mohammed Hazime (Sr.)
LB	4	Rocco Nicholl* (Sr.)	15	Sayed Abuhamedeh (Jr.)
LB	10	Hayden Dawahare* (Jr.)	24	Tanner Mintz (Fr.)
LB	32	Trey Rubinstein (So.)	34	Rafael Terrero Jr. (Fr.)
CB	1	A'tiq Muhammad (Sr.)	27	Lennox Lemon (Fr.)
CB	22	Davion Pritchard* (So.)	7	Angelo Stockstill (Jr.)
S	21	Joel Cordoba (So.)	18	Norey Johnson* (Sr.)
S	31	DERRICK JACKSON III (SO.)	19	DJ Barnes (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	96	Sean Leonard (Fr.)	KR	30	Da'Realyst Clark (Sr.)
P	97	Jake Stoeckel (Fr.)	PR	6	Wayne Harris (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



THOMAS GOTKOWSKI

SCOUTING THE REDHAWKS

"They don't get fazed by anything — tough, gritty. They don't turn the football over. They don't do anything crazy on offense. They're gonna run the football, but what they do really well is make that one of the best special teams coordinator jobs in the country. They replace those coordinators and just keep that thing going. They're always one of the top-25 most efficient special teams units in the country. ... Their fundamentals show up on film. They coach those players hard, and they get the right kids that fit into what they do. I don't think the NIL stuff is gonna change their approach. They're pretty simple schematically on defense, but it doesn't matter because they have all the answers to it. They just don't do anything stupid."

— An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	17	Braylon Isom (So.)	4	Devin Hyatt* (Jr.)
WR	0	KEITH REYNOLDS (JR.)	3	Quintin Simmons* (Fr.)
WR	12	Carl Jenkins* (So.)	1	Maleek Huggins* (Sr.)
WR	2	Brady Simmons (Sr.)	8	Damarion Witten* (Jr.)
LT	51	ERIC SMITH (SR.)	71	Lucas Barnes (Fr.)
LG	61	Andrew Lowry (Jr.)	78	Devontae Armstrong* (So.)
C	72	KRIS MANU (SO.)	76	Brian Beidatsch* (Sr.)
RG	74	GREG SMITH JR. (JR.)	73	Brandon Lawhorn Moore (Sr.)
RT	54	Evan Malcore* (Sr.)	77	Shaun Shahu* (Sr.)
QB	13	Thomas Gotkowski (So.)	16	David McComb* (Fr.)
RB	5	Rodney Nelson* (Jr.)	20	Cade Yacamelli (Sr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	22	Bai Jobe (Jr.)	5	Devin Bell (So.)
DT	99	OJ Alexander (So.)	14	Mikah Coleman* (Sr.)
DT	92	ROOSEVELT ANDREWS III (JR.)	47	Brach Rice (So.)
DE	43	Grant Lyons (Sr.)	32	James Schott (Jr.)
LB	15	Blaine Myrick (Sr.)	3	MALCOLM MCCAIN (JR.)
LB	8	CJ Young* (Jr.)	11	Brock Uihlein (Jr.)
CB	12	KALEB MARTIN (JR.)	0	Amariyun Knighten* (Sr.)
CB	6	Adrian Walker Jr. (So.)	21	Toney Coleman Jr. (Jr.)
NB	26	Eli Coppess (Sr.)	15	Blayne Myrick* (Sr.)
S	24	Mychal Yharbrough (Sr.)	2	Jackson Pons (So.)
S	28	Leo Colombi (So.)	29	Easton Jointer (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	38	Kellan McLaughlin (Jr.)	KR	0	Keith Reynolds (Jr.)
P	34	Pierre Stainton (Sr.)	PR	10	Jermaine Agee (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



MIAMI (OHIO) REDHAWKS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 86 | MAC PREDICTION: 1 | 2025 RECORD: 7-7, 6-2 MAC

OFFENSE Sophomore Thomas Gotkowski is expected to be QB1 in the fall after taking the reins late last season. He sparked a stagnant offense in his first two games with four TD passes, but both he and the offense regressed significantly in losses to Western Michigan in the MAC Championship Game and to Fresno State in the Arizona Bowl. Former Kansas backup David McComb is the secondary option.

Rodney Nelson is expected to get the bulk of the carries at running back for the RedHawks. He is transferring in from FCS Monmouth, where he was the CAA Player of the Year after rushing for 1,802 yards and 18 touchdowns. Wisconsin transfer Cade Yacamelli will be there in a supporting role, and it will be interesting to see if there is a timeshare, which the RedHawks typically employ.

Miami mostly uses four wideouts, and almost all the receivers will be newcomers. Transfers Quintin Simmons (Kentucky), Devin Hyatt (Arizona) and Damarion Witten (Ohio State) bring Power 4 credibility.

Left tackle Eric Smith was third-team All-MAC a year ago, and fellow third-team honoree Evan Malcore, a Northern Illinois transfer, joins him.

DEFENSE The strongest unit on a defense that has been top five in the MAC four years running will be the linebackers. CJ Young, a second-team All-MAC performer at Kent State, is transferring in, and fellow newcomer Blayne Myrick was a first-team All-Sun Belt honoree at South Alabama. Both should contend for all-conference honors. Malcolm McCain is the team's leading returning tackler, and Brock Uihlein is also a steady performer.

On the defensive line, rotational players will step in alongside returning starter Roosevelt Andrews III, and Bai Jobe, Devin Bell and Grant Lyons are among the edge rushers.

Miami lost its starting safeties, both of whom were among the best in the conference, although Mychal Yharbrough impressed in the spring.

SPECIALISTS Junior Kellan McLaughlin has been the kickoff specialist for three years, but with the departure of all-league placekicker Dom Dzioban, McLaughlin will add field goals and extra points to his duties. Punter Pierre Stainton averaged 42.3 yards per kick last season.

FINAL ANALYSIS Miami has been to three straight MAC title games, and there is a good chance for a fourth if the higher-end transfers turn out to be as good as advertised. The offense should be improved as Gotkowski gains more experience and Nelson emerges at running back, and head coach Chuck Martin consistently fields a strong defense.

2025 RESULTS (7-7, 6-2 MAC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 28	at Wisconsin	L	0-17	Sept. 5	at Pitt	1. Dominik Kosznicki, OT	★★★★
Sept. 6	at Rutgers	L	17-45	Sept. 12	Holy Cross	2. Andrew Bellisari, QB	★★★
Sept. 20	UNLV	L	38-41	Sept. 19	at Cincinnati #	3. Tommy Thies, S	★★★
Sept. 27	Lindenwood	W	38-0	Sept. 26	UConn	4. William Pressley, WR	★★★
Oct. 4	at Northern Illinois	W	25-14	Oct. 3	Bowling Green	5. Ike Steward, RB	★★★
Oct. 11	at Akron	W	20-7	Oct. 10	at UMass	6. Brody Sink, LB	★★★
Oct. 18	Eastern Michigan	W	44-30	Oct. 17	Akron	7. Zach Hultgren, WR	★★★
Oct. 25	Western Michigan	W	26-17	Oct. 24	at Central Michigan	8. Justen Hodge, WR	★★★
Nov. 4	at Ohio	L	20-24	Nov. 3	Buffalo	9. L. Shackleford-Vickroy, EDGE	★★★
Nov. 12	Toledo	L	3-24	Nov. 10	Ohio	10. Tristan Reed, WR	★★★
Nov. 19	at Buffalo	W	37-20	Nov. 17	at Kent State		
Nov. 29	Ball State	W	45-24	Nov. 24	at W. Michigan		
Dec. 6	vs. W. Michigan #	L	13-23		#TQL Stadium		*Per Rivals
Dec. 27	vs. Fresno State %	L	3-18				
#Detroit %Arizona Bowl				TEAM INFORMATION			
				Head Coach: Chuck Martin • Record at School: 72-74 (12 years)			
				Career Record: 146-81 (18 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Gus Ragland			
				Defensive Coordinator: Bill Brechin • Location: Oxford, Ohio			
				Stadium: Yager Stadium (24,286)			



OHIO BOBCATS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 111 | MAC PREDICTION: 5 | 2025 RECORD: 9-4, 6-2 MAC

OFFENSE Offensive coordinator Scott Isphording is back, and that's about it. The Bobcats lost nearly all of their offensive production to graduation or the transfer portal. The biggest storyline is under center, where a mix of inexperienced returners and highly productive FCS New Hampshire transfer Matt Vezza will compete for the starting job.

The ground game says goodbye to 1,300-yard rusher Sieh Bangura, but returnee Duncan Brune (585 yards, eight TDs) and UConn transfer Victor Rosa (302 total yards, three TDs) provide adequate reinforcements. At receiver, Ohio benefits from experienced targets like Dom Dorwart, Max Rodarte and Eian Pugh, who combined for 24 receptions and 280 yards. Whoever wins the QB battle will have reliable options on key downs.

The offensive line is almost entirely rebuilt through the transfer portal. It's one of the most uncertain position groups entering 2026, with all five starters having departed. Ohio's staff targeted size and experience through the portal. The goal is to maintain the physical identity that has defined the program's rushing attack in recent years.

DEFENSE Ohio's defense will dictate its win-loss record. Linebackers Jack Fries and Michael Molnar return to anchor the unit, along with defensive linemen Austin Mitchell, Nehemiah Dukes and Derek Reagans. The secondary has a blend of returnees and transfers that hopes to lock down opposing quarterbacks and wide receivers.

Defensive coordinator Kurt Mattix was on the 2024 Ohio staff. Now, he's back to implement an aggressive, attacking style that prioritizes disruption at the line of scrimmage and increased pressure. The philosophical shift could pay dividends if the front seven adapts quickly.

While the talent level appears solid, execution in a new system often takes time. If the defense can quickly adjust and create negative plays, it has the potential to become one of the more impactful units in the MAC.

SPECIALISTS Magnus Haines was one of the top punters in the MAC last season, averaging 42.3 yards per punt. Placekicker Will Hryszko transferred from Kent State, where he made all 31 extra points and went 8-of-11 on field goals. Brune and Rodarte give the Bobcats big-play ability in the return game.

FINAL ANALYSIS For the third consecutive season, Ohio is dealing with a coaching change. That's difficult enough, but in the transfer portal era, it's only exacerbated. The Bobcats are facing this season with a mostly brand-new roster. Head coach John Hauser is at least a familiar face, as he spent the previous three seasons on the staff. But can he sustain the momentum that Ohio has built with 40 wins over the past four years?

2025 RESULTS (9-4, 6-2 MAC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 28	at Rutgers	L	31-34	Sept. 5	at Nebraska	1. Brandon Jenkins, ATH	★★★
Sept. 6	West Virginia	W	17-10	Sept. 12	Jacksonville State	2. Danny Fortson Jr., IOL	★★★
Sept. 13	at Ohio State	L	9-37	Sept. 19	at South Alabama	3. Kindall Brown, CB	★★★
Sept. 20	Gardner-Webb	W	52-35	Sept. 26	Stonehill	4. Kaden Page, WR	★★★
Sept. 27	Bowling Green	W	35-20	Oct. 3	at Kent State	5. Marcus Hughbanks, WR	★★★
Oct. 4	at Ball State	L	14-20	Oct. 10	Central Michigan	6. Colton Crosley, IOL	★★★
Oct. 18	Northern Illinois	W	48-21	Oct. 17	at Sacramento St.	7. Levi Davis, QB	★★★
Oct. 25	at Eastern Michigan	W	28-21	Oct. 24	Eastern Michigan	8. Job Mavrick, IOL	★★★
Nov. 4	Miami (Ohio)	W	24-20	Nov. 3	at Akron	9. Austin Adkins, DL	★★★
Nov. 11	at Western Michigan	L	13-17	Nov. 10	at Miami (Ohio)	10. Mike Montgomery, OT	★★★
Nov. 18	UMass	W	42-14	Nov. 17	Ball State		
Nov. 28	at Buffalo	W	31-26	Nov. 27	Toledo		*Per Rivals
Dec. 23	vs. UNLV #	W	17-10				
#Frisco Bowl				TEAM INFORMATION			
				Head Coach: John Hauser • Record at School: 1-0 (1 year)			
				Career Record: 1-0 (1 year) • Offensive Coordinator: Scott Isphording			
				Defensive Coordinator: Kurt Mattix • Location: Athens, Ohio			
				Stadium: Peden Stadium (24,000)			



JACK FRIES

SCOUTING THE BOBCATS

"The [former head coach Brian Smith resignation] was shocking. I thought he did a great job picking up where Tim Albin left off. Now, keeping it in-house with John Hauser, I don't expect a drop-off because they do a really good job of recruiting and evaluation. They do a great job of recruiting high school kids and developing them. I see more of a plug-and-play situation with them with somebody who has probably been sitting on the bench the last couple of years developing and can now get on the field. ... [Departed quarterback] Parker Navarro was really, really good for this conference. That's gonna be the hardest one to replace, but everywhere else, I see plug-and-play with the guys that they've recruited from high school."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	0	Delaney Crawford (Sr.)	2	Preston Bowman* (Fr.)
WR	3	Max Rodarte (Sr.)	10	Ian Ver Steeg* (Sr.)
WR	19	DOM DORWART (SO.)	12	Eian Pugh (Sr.)
LT	75	Jarian Shelby (Sr.)	77	Sandro Malicevic* (Sr.)
LG	65	Josh Waite (Sr.)	72	Trumain Lawson* (Fr.)
C	71	Cassius Hulbert* (Sr.)	76	Bryce Parson (So.)
RG	55	CJ Dawson II* (Sr.)	63	Seth Anstead (So.)
RT	74	Tigana Cisse (Sr.)	70	Joshua Johnson (Sr.)
TE	84	AJ Miller (So.)	86	Andrew Metzger* (So.)
QB	9	Matt Vezza* (Jr.)	8	Nick Poulos (Sr.)
RB	6	Duncan Brune (Jr.)	23	Victor Rosa* (Sr.)

DEFENSE (5)

DE	9	Tyler Gillison* (Sr.)	23	Joseph Marsh (Jr.)
DT	0	NEHEMIAH DUKES (SR.)	57	Nathan Hale (Sr.)
DT	97	Austin Mitchell (Jr.)	98	Derek Reagans (Sr.)
OLB	27	JACK FRIES (SR.)	34	Lukas Stiles (Jr.)
ILB	25	MICHAEL MOLNAR (SR.)	12	Jermaine Minnis (Fr.)
ILB	30	CHARLIE CHRISTOPHER (SO.)	56	Cody Raymond* (So.)
HUSKY	4	Darren James-Hamilton* (So.)	49	Xavier Williams (So.)
CB	8	Barry Dillon* (So.)	20	Kendall Bannister (Jr.)
CB	21	Ronald Jackson Jr. (Sr.)	6	Tony Mathis (Jr.)
S	2	DJ WALKER (JR.)	13	DJ Morton (So.)
S	7	Eli Thompson* (Jr.)	3	JT Haskins (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	47	Will Hryszko* (Sr.)	KR	6	Duncan Brune (Jr.)
P	42	Magnus Haines (Sr.)	PR	3	Max Rodarte (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



DEREK HOUSTON

SCOUTING THE HORNETS

"I think it's gonna be better that [former head coach] Brennan Marion isn't there anymore. He was able to bring in recruits where they were maybe on their second or third school after starting at an SEC school when they shouldn't have been there in the first place. ... Hopefully with them jumping up to the MAC, it may help them with the high school recruiting. In California, there aren't a lot of small schools out there. Those kids always have to leave to go to other schools. Maybe they can attract those types of kids. But it'll be a challenge for them at first because there's a difference between the Midwest and the West Coast, and traveling to the Midwest to play a November Tuesday game is gonna be different. It's gonna be hard."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	2	Matt Coleman* (Sr.)	4	Kenyon Shabazz* (Jr.)
WR	12	Onterio Smith Jr. (Jr.)	7	Khai Taylor* (Jr.)
WR	10	Jace Wilson (Sr.)	83	Jaxon Fresques (So.)
LT	71	Bryson Summers (Sr.)	55	Garrison Blank* (Fr.)
LG	64	Brandon Sousa (Jr.)	63	Graysen Lee (Fr.)
C	66	Hayden Frazier* (Jr.)	57	Luke Slater (So.)
RG	74	Vae Soifua* (Sr.)	75	DeAnthony Sheffield (Jr.)
RT	77	Jeremiah Stallworth (So.)	68	Davis May (Jr.)
TE	16	JORDAN WILLIAMS (SR.)	88	Cedric Anton* (Jr.)
QB	17	Carson Conklin* (Jr.)	8	Jackson Sharman* (Jr.)
RB	1	Jamar Curtis (Sr.)	14	Curron Borders (So.)

DEFENSE (2)

DE	45	XAVIER WILLIAMS (SR.)	99	Devyn Blake (Fr.)
DT	58	Jamel Howard* (Jr.)	9	Malik Tullis (Sr.)
DT	90	Austin Chambers* (So.)	97	Nick Dimitris* (Sr.)
LB	18	Fata Puloka (Jr.)	44	Diego Davis (Sr.)
LB	10	Derek Houston (Jr.)	33	ALEX ROCHA (SR.)
LB	8	Darson Jeanty* (Sr.)	26	Tim Thomas* (Sr.)
CB	22	Elias Mullican (Sr.)	2	Dionte Thornton* (Sr.)
CB	12	Malikai Nichols* (So.)	29	Caleb Reese (Fr.)
S	1	Boogsie Silvera* (Sr.)	38	Diesel Gordon (Jr.)
S	3	Amari Wallace* (Fr.)	6	Warren Smith Jr. (Jr.)
S	25	Naytel Mitchell (Fr.)	7	Noah King* (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	49	Grant Meadors (Jr.)	KR	1	Jamar Curtis (Sr.)
P	35	Jay Brockhaus* (Jr.)	PR	83	Jaxon Fresques (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



SACRAMENTO STATE HORNETS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 136 | MAC PREDICTION: 12 | 2025 RECORD: 7-5, 5-3 FCS BIG SKY

OFFENSE The Hornets welcome back quarterback Carson Conklin after one year at Fresno State. Conklin spent the first two seasons of his college career with Sacramento State, earning Freshman All-America honors at the FCS level and finishing third in voting for the Jerry Rice Award, given to the FCS' top freshman. He was a full-time starter in 2024 but led the Hornets to only three wins. He did complete 62% of his passes with 28 touchdowns and 12 interceptions before leaving for Fresno State. With the Bulldogs, Conklin moved into a starting role late in the year.

Conklin has some weapons in running backs Jamar Curtis and Curron Borders. Curtis was an FCS All-American at Lafayette who transferred to Sac State for 2025. He was injured most of last season, but he had more than 3,500 total yards and 35 touchdowns over three years at Lafayette.

New head coach Alonzo Carter will be starting over at wide receiver as the position hit the transfer portal almost as a unit. Matt Coleman has significant experience coming over from San José State, and Onterio Smith Jr. has seen action in 20 games with the Hornets over two years.

The offensive line will also have to be rebuilt around Bryson Summers, who saw extensive action last year, and Jeremiah Stallworth.

DEFENSE The best unit for the Hornets clearly will be their linebackers. Derek Houston and Alex Rocha are both back after a frustrating 2025 that saw only one quarter where both were healthy at the same time. Houston and Rocha are 100% in spring ball and will be critical in the middle of a unit that will be adapting to a new 3-3-5 scheme under defensive coordinator Adam Clark.

The defensive line was shifting players during the spring to see who would be in the rotation. Wisconsin transfer defensive tackle Jamel Howard won a starting job in the spring.

The secondary will also be a complete overhaul, with Boogsie Silvera arriving at safety after stops at FCS schools Charleston Southern and McNeese and another at USF.

SPECIALISTS Grant Meadors returns as the Hornets' kicker. The former Oregon Duck hit 12 of his 15 field goals in his first year in Sacramento with a long of 42. The punter situation won't be finalized until the fall.

FINAL ANALYSIS Sacramento State will likely struggle in its first year in the Mid-American Conference with a first-time head coach and a roster that was built on the idea it would be competing as an FCS Independent. Only after the transfer portal closed did Sacramento State receive an invitation to the MAC. There are questions along both lines, which is never good when a team is stepping up a level.

2025 RESULTS (7-5, 5-3 FCS BIG SKY)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	at South Dakota State	L	3-20	Aug. 29	at Eastern Michigan	1. Devyn Blake, DL	★★★
Sept. 6	at Nevada	L	17-20	Sept. 5	Miss. Valley St.	2. Lekhi Holani, LB	★★★
Sept. 13	Mercyhurst	W	49-28	Sept. 12	at Fresno State	3. Joshua Holani, S	★★★
Sept. 20	Central Arkansas	W	45-16	Sept. 19	North Dakota State	4. Daniel Swinney, RB	★★★
Sept. 27	Cal Poly	L	24-32	Sept. 26	UMass	5. Khai Taylor, WR	★★★
Oct. 11	at Weber State	W	55-27	Oct. 10	at Bowling Green	6. Dezmyn Hardy, WR	★★★
Oct. 18	Northern Colorado	W	40-35	Oct. 17	Ohio	7. Peyton McCutcheon, LB	★★★
Oct. 24	Montana	L	35-49	Oct. 24	at Ball State	8. Jiah Walls, LB	★★★
Nov. 1	at E. Washington	W	35-13	Oct. 30	Kent State	9. Liam Meeker, QB	★★★
Nov. 8	at Portland State	W	52-24	Nov. 4	Toledo	10. Carlton Perrilliat, WR	★★★
Nov. 15	Idaho	W	23-20	Nov. 11	at Central Michigan		
Nov. 22	at UC Davis	L	27-31	Nov. 28	at Hawai'i		

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Alonzo Carter • Record at School: First Season • Career Record: First Season • Offensive Coordinators: Eric Kiesau, Eric Scott • Defensive Coordinators: Adam Clark, Kenwick Thompson • Location: Sacramento, Calif. • Stadium: Hornet Stadium (21,955)



TOLEDO ROCKETS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 99 | MAC PREDICTION: 4 | 2025 RECORD: 8-5, 6-2 MAC

OFFENSE Amid all the turnover that followed head coach Jason Candle's departure to UConn, the quarterback position is something of a known commodity. Junior John Alan Richter returns after serving as a backup the past two seasons and has shown flashes in limited opportunities. He had three starts as a redshirt freshman in 2024 and some backup duty in 2025, and he has completed 66% of his passes with seven TDs and one INT.

Running back CJ Miller is one of 14 FCS Mercer transfers who followed new head coach Mike Jacobs to Toledo, and he should be the top running back. Miller had 1,267 yards from scrimmage and scored 17 touchdowns for the Bears. Connor Walendzak led the Rockets in rushing two years ago and should also be a factor.

The offensive line welcomes back four players with starting experience, led by All-MAC candidate Stephen Gales at left tackle.

The wide receiver room is full of transfers, with Calvin Gilbert Jr. (FCS Southeast Missouri State), Anthony Simpson (Michigan) and Adjatay Dabbs (Mercer) making early impressions. Bryson Hammer should also be a factor after being primarily a punt returner thus far in his career.

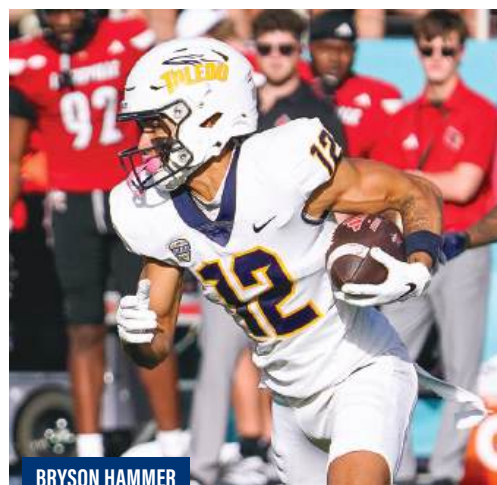
DEFENSE The most important player arriving from Mercer with Jacobs is defensive end Andrew Zock, the FCS Defensive Player of the Year in 2025. Zock, who had 20 tackles for a loss and 11.5 sacks, decided to stay with Jacobs despite Power 4 offers and will be the leader on the defense.

How the transfers adjust will be the story. Linebacker Kari Jackson spent two seasons at Penn State and was making an early impression in the spring. Linebackers Julian Fox and Isaac Prince earned All-Southern Conference honors at Mercer. Safety Armorion Smith is spending his final season at Toledo after seeing seven starts at Michigan State. Corner Cam Jones was an All-Patriot League player at FCS Holy Cross, and former Div. III nickel Mo Conteh was turning heads in the spring as well.

SPECIALISTS Kicker Reice Griffith was 14-for-17 on field goals last season at Mercer, with half his makes coming from beyond 40 yards. The punter position is up for grabs between returner Emilio Duran and two newcomers. Hammer will be the primary punt returner after leading the MAC in punt return yardage the past two seasons.

FINAL ANALYSIS Jacobs has a track record of success, most recently going 15-1 in Southern Conference play at Mercer the past two seasons. Toledo has not had a losing record in 16 years, and the new staff is confident that this won't be a slow build despite essentially starting with a brand-new roster. How well the Mercer transfer contingent adjusts will determine whether the Rockets can continue to be an upper-level MAC program.

2025 RESULTS (8-5, 6-2 MAC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	at Kentucky	L	16-24	Sept. 5	at Michigan State	1. Sharard Vaughn III, LB	★★★★
Sept. 6	WKU	W	45-21	Sept. 12	Central Conn. St.	2. Jake Palucki, IOL	★★★★
Sept. 13	Morgan State	W	60-0	Sept. 19	Temple	3. Seth Elchert, WR	★★★★
Sept. 20	at Western Michigan	L	13-14	Sept. 26	San Diego State	4. Tyrell O'Neal, DL	★★★★
Sept. 27	Akron	W	45-3	Oct. 3	at Ball State	5. Ziyahn Blair, S	★★★★
Oct. 11	at Bowling Green	L	23-28	Oct. 10	Buffalo	6. Mac Capen, LB	★★★★
Oct. 18	Kent State	W	45-10	Oct. 17	at Eastern Michigan	7. Hayden Roy, LB	★★★★
Oct. 25	at Washington State	L	7-28	Oct. 24	Western Michigan	8. Brian Stovall Jr., LB	★★★★
Nov. 5	Northern Illinois	W	42-3	Nov. 4	at Sacramento St.	9. Preston Dazey, OT	★★★★
Nov. 12	at Miami (Ohio)	W	24-3	Nov. 11	UMass	10. Zack Samuel, EDGE	★★★★
Nov. 22	Ball State	W	38-9	Nov. 18	Bowling Green		
Nov. 29	at Central Michigan	W	21-3	Nov. 27	at Ohio		
Dec. 23	vs. Louisville #	L	22-27				
#Boca Raton Bowl				TEAM INFORMATION Head Coach: Mike Jacobs • Record at School: First Season Career Record: 94-23 (10 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Cris Reisert Defensive Coordinator: Jahmal Brown • Location: Toledo, Ohio Stadium: Glass Bowl (26,038)			



BRYSON HAMMER

SCOUTING THE ROCKETS

"I thought they were the best team in the MAC last year. A lot of these guys were NFL prospects going into their senior year, and they didn't leave. That speaks to what [former head coach Jason] Candle did there. For the last 10 years, they were the class of the MAC. ... I don't know it's necessarily just the loss of Candle [to UConn]. I think that it's more about the amount of players that they lost vs. what they brought in. They're losing a potential first-round safety [Emmanuel McNeil-Warren], which always hurts, and I think that their tight end that they lost, CC Ezirim [transferred to WKU], is gonna be a really good player. ... Yes, there was relief when Candle left, but [new head coach] Mike Jacobs has won at every level, and he's done a great job."

—An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (I)

WR	12	Bryson Hammer (Jr.)	3	Adjatay Dabbs* (Jr.)
WR	9	Kalvin Gilbert Jr.* (Jr.)	1	Rico Bond* (So.)
WR	85	Anthony Simpson* (Sr.)	14	Tashi Braceful (So.)
LT	65	STEPHEN GALES (SR.)	71	Matt Hofer (So.)
LG	73	Jonathan Harder (Sr.)	62	Christian Medlock (Jr.)
C	78	Dylan Senda* (Jr.)	50	Luke Rector* (Jr.)
RG	74	Ahmad Carwise* (So.)	69	Dominic Johnson* (So.)
RT	55	Ibrahim Traore (Sr.)	70	Nick Thomas* (Sr.)
TE	88	Jacob Newell* (Sr.)	80	Peyton Strickland* (Sr.)
QB	6	John Alan Richter (Jr.)	7	Khamoni Robinson* (Jr.)
RB	22	CJ Miller* (Jr.)	4	Autavius Ison* (Jr.)

DEFENSE (O)

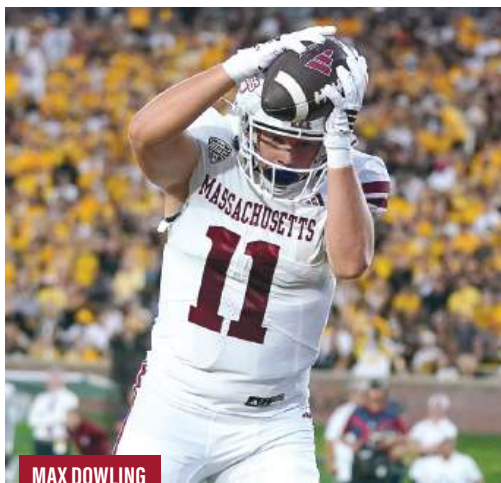
DE	0	Andrew Zock* (Jr.)	90	Zach Johnson* (So.)
DT	99	Caden Camese* (Sr.)	41	Cam Gwinn (Fr.)
DT	52	Lucas Lambert-Pipkin (Jr.)	96	Nathaniel Chandler (Jr.)
DE	5	Damon Ollison II (Sr.)	2	Ezra Odinojr* (Jr.)
LB	6	Langston Long (Sr.)	44	Isaac Zay (So.)
LB	10	Julian Fox* (Jr.)	13	Kari Jackson* (So.)
CB	11	Hyajah Miller (So.)	25	Tyrell Russell (Fr.)
CB	1	Cam Jones* (Jr.)	23	Israel Petite* (So.)
NB	12	Mo Conteh* (Sr.)	17	Kaleb Hutchinson* (Sr.)
S	22	Nicholas Thompson (Jr.)	39	Dylan Hohler (Jr.)
S	4	Donovan Watkins* (Jr.)	7	Armorion Smith* (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	93	Reice Griffith* (Sr.)	KR	1	Rico Bond* (So.)
P	36	Emilio Duran (Sr.)	PR	12	Bryson Hammer (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

JEFF ROMANCE-IMAGN IMAGES



MAX DOWLING

SCOUTING THE MINUTEMEN

"You know what's weird? Now that they're in the MAC, I actually think that it should be a really good job. I think [head coach] Joe Harasymiak is a good coach. There is enough talent because there's no other program like that outside of maybe Delaware in the Northeast, where you have that level of player. Like, not the Power 4 player but not an FCS player, either. ... I think that they'll have a chance at some point because of their investment, but their roster was just so bad. It looks like it's an uphill battle, but unlike the rest of the MAC where they're all fighting over the same players, they're the only game in town in the whole Northeast at that level. They'll have a chance at some point, but I don't know if they can win enough games right now."

— An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (2)

WR	10	T.Y. Harding (Sr.)	9	Devin Matthews* (Jr.)
WR	1	Joseph Griffin Jr.* (Sr.)	3	Elijah Pedro (Fr.)
WR	8	Kezion Dia-Johnson (So.)	17	Dallas Elliott (Sr.)
LT	66	Greg Knox* (Sr.)	77	Jaxon King (Sr.)
LG	69	Brock Taylor (So.)	65	Samu Suominen (Fr.)
C	64	Peyton Miller (Jr.)	75	Tanner Burlingame (So.)
RG	79	Aitor Urionabarrenechea* (Jr.)	65	Samu Suominen (Fr.)
RT	73	Zachary Franks (Sr.)	77	Jaxon King (Sr.)
TE	11	MAX DOWLING (SR.)	83	REECE ADKINS (SR.)
QB	5	William Watson III* (Jr.)	2	RJ Johnson III* (Jr.)
RB	0	Jordan Washington* (So.)	23	Elijah Faulkner (So.)

DEFENSE (4)

DE	2	Joshua Nobles (Sr.)	9	Justin Krueger* (So.)
DT	90	Tim Passmore Jr. (Sr.)	55	Zakar Morris* (So.)
DT	10	Aubrey Melvin* (Fr.)	99	Kamarion Thomas* (Fr.)
DE	42	Andrew DePaape* (Jr.)	98	William DePaape* (So.)
LB	5	TYLER MARTIN (SR.)	6	Joshua Iseah* (Sr.)
LB	44	TIMMY HINSPIETER (SR.)	6	Joshua Iseah* (Sr.)
CB	7	TJ Magee (Sr.)	4	Chris Stanley* (So.)
CB	0	Isaiah Reed* (Sr.)	23	JC Clark (Fr.)
NB	8	Michael Robinson (Sr.)	21	Terron Johnson (Fr.)
S	3	KENDALL BOURNES (SR.)	1	DD Snyder (Sr.)
S	38	ZERAUN DANIEL (SR.)	20	Keith Sarkodieh (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	99	Derek Morris (Jr.)	KR	10	T.Y. Harding (Sr.)
P	43	Edward Phillipson (So.)	PR	7	TJ Magee (Sr.)

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UMASS MINUTEMEN

NATIONAL FORECAST: 138 | MAC PREDICTION: 13 | 2025 RECORD: 0-12, 0-8 MAC

OFFENSE There is excitement surrounding the arrival of quarterback Williams "Pop" Watson III, who was a local star in Springfield before playing for three years at Virginia Tech. Watson could never win the permanent QB1 job in Blacksburg, but he showed flashes and has taken control of a dormant UMass offense that finished last in the nation in scoring average (11.1 ppg) and yards per game (247.5) last season.

Wide receiver T.Y. Harding is back after missing the final nine games last season and should be Watson's top target. Another receiver to watch will be Watson's high school teammate, Joseph Griffin Jr., who comes back to UMass after two years at Boston College and one at Wisconsin. New offensive coordinator Max Warner, who coached tight end Harold Fannin Jr. to All-America status at Bowling Green, will feature tight ends Max Dowling and Reece Adkins.

FCS Murray State transfer Jordan Washington will be the top back behind a revamped offensive line that needed that revamping. Left guard Brock Taylor returns after starting four games last season, with left tackle Greg Knox (FCS McNeese) joining as a transfer and right tackle Zachary Franks coming back from an injury that cost him the season.

DEFENSE The Minutemen welcome two critical players back from injury. Defensive end Joshua Nobles, who might have been the team's top player, missed all of last season. Cornerback TJ Magee will bolster the secondary and also return punts after he missed the final nine games last season.

The linebackers are productive and experienced. Tyler Martin is an All-MAC candidate after recording 104 tackles with an interception and fumble recovery last season. Timmy Hinspeter averaged 9.9 tackles per game in his seven games before an injury ended his campaign.

Both starting safeties — Zeraun Daniel and Kendall Bournes — are back. Transfer Isaiah Reed turned heads in the spring and will pair with Magee at cornerback.

SPECIALISTS Kicker Derek Morris was 10-of-16 on field goals, including 3-of-5 from 50-plus. Australian Edward Phillipson takes over at punter with Magee and Harding giving UMass a threat in the return game.

FINAL ANALYSIS Several key injuries decimated a thin roster last season and kept UMass from being competitive. If the Minutemen can stay healthier and Watson lives up to expectations at quarterback, UMass will be capable of competing most weeks in the MAC. Its 16-game losing streak entering the season is the nation's longest, and the average margin of defeat during the streak is 26.8 points. The streak should end in September with FCS Sacred Heart and Stonehill as well as FBS newcomer Sacramento State on the schedule.

2025 RESULTS (0-12, 0-8 MAC)

Aug. 30	Temple	L	10-42
Sept. 6	Bryant	L	26-27
Sept. 13	at Iowa	L	7-47
Sept. 27	at Missouri	L	6-42
Oct. 4	Western Michigan	L	3-21
Oct. 11	at Kent State	L	6-42
Oct. 18	Buffalo	L	21-28
Oct. 25	at Central Michigan	L	13-38
Nov. 4	at Akron	L	10-44
Nov. 12	Northern Illinois	L	3-45
Nov. 18	at Ohio	L	14-42
Nov. 25	Bowling Green	L	14-45

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 3	at Rutgers
Sept. 12	Sacred Heart
Sept. 19	Stonehill
Sept. 26	at Sacramento St.
Oct. 3	Eastern Michigan
Oct. 10	Miami (Ohio)
Oct. 17	at Buffalo
Oct. 24	at UConn
Nov. 4	Ball State
Nov. 11	at Toledo
Nov. 18	Akron
Nov. 28	at Bowling Green

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Aedan McCarthy, QB	★★★
2.	Kareem Pruitt, CB	★★★
3.	Terron Johnson, CB	★★★
4.	Corey Warner, CB	★★★
5.	David Moore Jr., ATH	★★★
6.	Will McNamara, IOL	★★★
7.	Donovan Murphy, EDGE	★★★
8.	CJ Amobi, EDGE	★★★
9.	Samuel Mulbah, DL	★★★
10.	Justin Lewis, RB	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Joe Harasymiak • Record at School: 0-12 (1 year) • Career Record: 20-27 (4 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Max Warner • Defensive Coordinator: Jared Keyte • Location: Amherst, Mass. • Stadium: Warren McGuirk Alumni Stadium (17,000)



WESTERN MICHIGAN BRONCOS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 87 | MAC PREDICTION: 2 | 2025 RECORD: 10-4, 7-1 MAC

OFFENSE Western Michigan’s MAC championship offense ran the ball 67% of the time last season, and that doesn’t figure to change much with Offensive Player of the Year Broc Lowry back at quarterback and third-team All-MAC performer Jalen Buckley back at running back. Lowry ran for 963 yards and 14 touchdowns, and Buckley had 1,003 rushing yards and nine touchdowns.

MAC Coach of the Year Lance Taylor is looking for Lowry to make strides in the passing game in his second season as the starter. Lowry completed 63% of his passes with nine TDs and three INTs, but his average of 6.9 yards per attempt could stand to improve.

The offensive line will again be strong, with three returning starters. At center, Jeremy Schleicher should return to action after missing most of 2025 with an injury.

At wide receiver, two of the top three receivers return in Baylin Brooks and Aveion Chenault, and Egypt Nelson turned heads in the spring.

DEFENSE The Broncos will have a tough time matching last year’s performance, when the unit allowed only 17.4 points per game to rank ninth nationally. They should be stout again, however. The top three corners are back, including Joshua Franklin, who was a third-team All-MAC selection. John Peters impressed as a true freshman at nickel last season. Safety Micah Davis, a former Michigan signee, returns after a productive season.

Dakari Frazier is ready for an increased role at defensive tackle, and the Broncos added transfers from Ohio State (Ahmed Tounkara) and North Carolina (Austin Alexander).

Linebackers Domanick Moon and Dillon Moore, who combined for 42 tackles in reserve roles, return, and Tennessee transfer Brenden Anes and juco transfer Justyce Betts bolster the unit.

SPECIALISTS Palmer Domschke was 10-for-13 on field goals from beyond 40 yards, and punter Ryan Millmore averaged 42.4 yards per kick with 11 of 50-plus. Juco transfer Kordell Gouldsby returned five kicks for touchdowns in two seasons at Hutchinson (Kan.) Community College.

FINAL ANALYSIS The Broncos lost just one projected returning starter to the transfer portal and were able to bring in 10 Power 4 transfers in the offseason. The defense will have to be rebuilt a bit — the team also lost Nadame Tucker (14.5 sacks, 21 TFLs) — but there is experience there. Expect Lowry to push the passing game forward in Year 2 as a starter. WMU closes with Miami (Ohio) at home, a game that should have MAC title game implications.

2025 RESULTS (10-4, 7-1 MAC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 29	at Michigan State	L	6-23	Sept. 5	at Michigan	1. Ryan Westrich, EDGE	★★★★
Sept. 6	North Texas (ot)	L	30-33	Sept. 12	Monmouth	2. Jaxson Dosh, QB	★★★★
Sept. 13	at Illinois	L	0-38	Sept. 19	at Rice	3. Donovan Triplett, RB	★★★★
Sept. 20	Toledo	W	14-13	Sept. 26	Boise State	4. Brodon Moore, CB	★★★★
Sept. 27	Rhode Island	W	47-14	Oct. 3	at Buffalo	5. Max Baker, DL	★★★★
Oct. 4	at UMass	W	21-3	Oct. 10	Kent State	6. Ryan Rocheleau, TE	★★★★
Oct. 11	Ball State	W	42-0	Oct. 17	at Central Michigan	7. Camari Patterson, S	★★★★
Oct. 25	at Miami (Ohio)	L	17-26	Oct. 24	at Toledo	8. Justyce Betts, LB	★★★★
Nov. 1	Central Michigan	W	24-21	Oct. 31	Bowling Green	9. Angelo Chapman, WR	★★★★
Nov. 11	Ohio	W	17-13	Nov. 10	at Akron	10. Muna Newman-Nwodika, EDGE	★★★★
Nov. 18	at Northern Illinois	W	35-19	Nov. 17	Eastern Michigan	*Per Rivals	
Nov. 25	at Eastern Michigan	W	31-21	Nov. 24	Miami (Ohio)		
Dec. 6	vs. Miami (Ohio) #	W	23-13	TEAM INFORMATION			
Dec. 19	vs. Kennesaw State %	W	41-6	Head Coach: Lance Taylor • Record at School: 20-19 (3 years)			
#Detroit %Myrtle Beach Bowl				Career Record: 20-19 (3 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Walt Bell			
				Defensive Coordinators: Greer Martini, Seth Payne • Location: Kalamazoo, Mich. • Stadium: Waldo Stadium (30,200)			



JALEN BUCKLEY

SCOUTING THE BRONCOS

"I think they're gonna repeat in the MAC. They're returning a quarterback, returning some key pieces and not losing a lot of guys in the portal. They did a good job of keeping their roster intact as much as they possibly could. The only way that they don't repeat is because in the MAC, any given Tuesday, you've gotta go to Athens, Ohio, or Muncie, Indiana, and they slip up in some game like that. ... I don't think [head coach] Lance Taylor is gonna be there for another year after this one. [The team's success is] a reflection of the athletic department. They're very invested in that university. Everything is going right at that school right now."

— An opposing MAC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (7)

WR	8	Egypt Nelson (Jr.)	11	Terence Marshall (So.)
WR	18	AVEION CHENAULT (SO.)	5	Kordell Gouldsby* (Jr.)
WR	82	BAYLIN BROOKS (JR.)	84	Keivin Boone-Nelson II (Sr.)
LT	76	CHAD SCHUSTER (SR.)	73	Ben Roebuck* (So.)
LG	58	Liam Vaughan (Fr.)	71	Brandon Smith* (Sr.)
C	65	Jeremy Schleicher (So.)	64	Nolan Miller (Fr.)
RG	72	GAVIN DABO (SO.)	64	Nolan Miller (Fr.)
RT	77	HUNTER WHITENACK (SR.)	73	Ben Roebuck* (So.)
TE	15	Adam Parks* (Jr.)	88	Nate Levicki* (Sr.)
QB	12	BROC LOWRY (JR.)	13	Mason Reynolds (So.)
RB	6	JALEN BUCKLEY (SR.)	24	Ofa "Lolo" Mataele (Sr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	2	Scoop Gardner Jr.* (Jr.)	4	Austin Alexander* (So.)
DT	94	Ahmed Tounkara* (So.)	96	Dalton Gustwiller (Jr.)
DT	98	Dakari Frazier (Jr.)	41	Zavian Tibbs* (Sr.)
LB	47	Domanick Moon (Sr.)	3	Brenden Anes* (So.)
LB	12	Dillon Moore (Sr.)	5	Justyce Betts* (So.)
CB	1	JOSHUA FRANKLIN (SR.)	22	Amarian Louis (Jr.)
CB	8	JARVARIUS SIMS (SR.)	24	John Peters (So.)
S	18	MICAH DAVIS (JR.)	19	Braden Steely (So.)
S	6	Joey Pope (Jr.)	21	CJ Miles Jr. (So.)
S	14	Daeh McCullough* (Jr.)		Kouri Crump* (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	20	Palmer Domschke (Sr.)	KR	5	Kordell Gouldsby* (Jr.)
P	25	Ryan Millmore (Jr.)	PR	5	Kordell Gouldsby* (Jr.)

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